

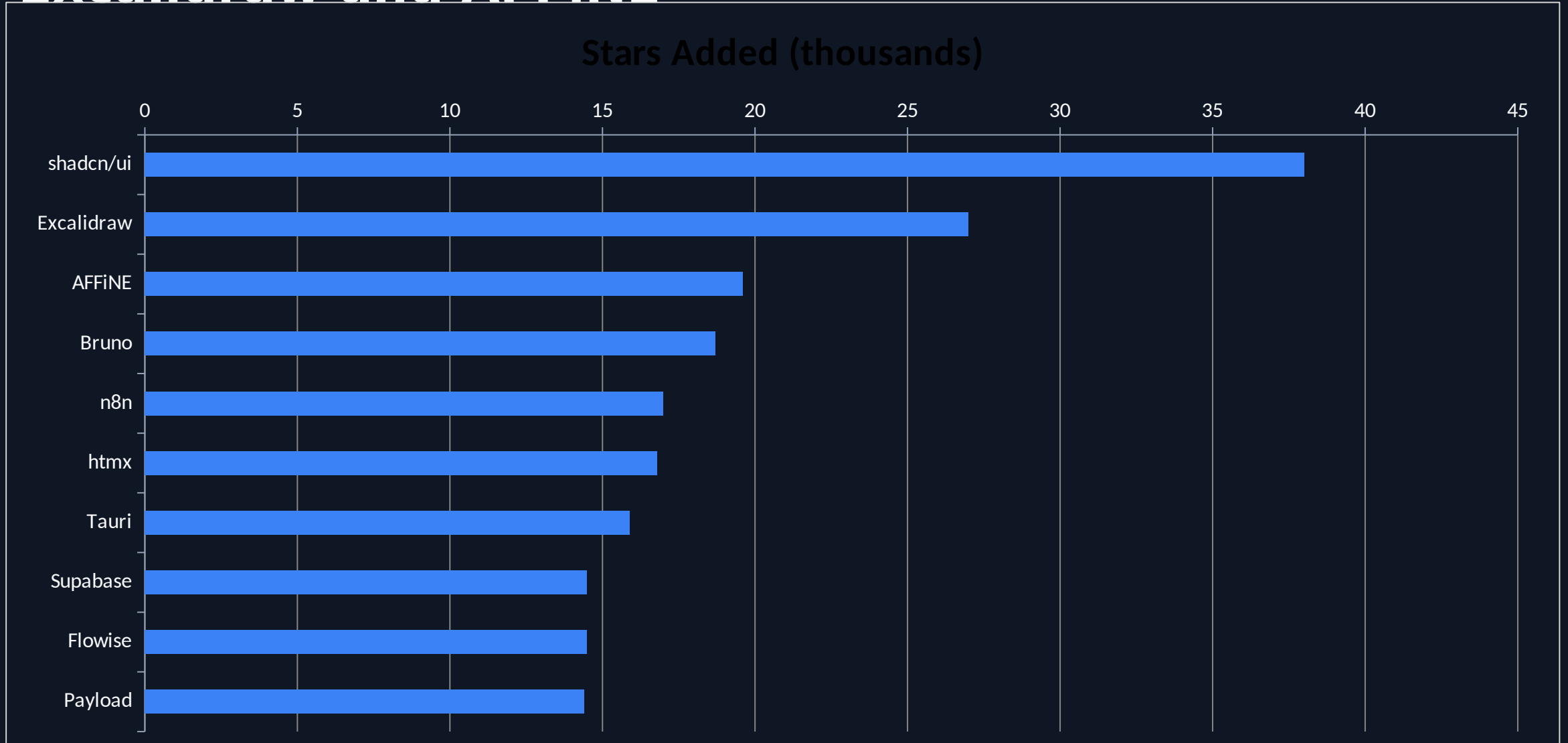
2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

The Year's Hottest Projects by GitHub Stars

9th Edition • Methodology: GitHub stars added in 2024 from Best of JS curated list

For frontend engineers and engineering managers tracking JavaScript ecosystem trends

shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars, Followed by Excalidraw and AFFiNE



shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Consecutive Year

Year-over-year growth

2023: +39.5k stars | 2024: +38.0k stars

Total stars reached 77.5k (created Jan 2023)

Sustained extraordinary momentum across both years

Key 2024 additions

Charts (powered by Recharts)

Themes (CSS variable generation)

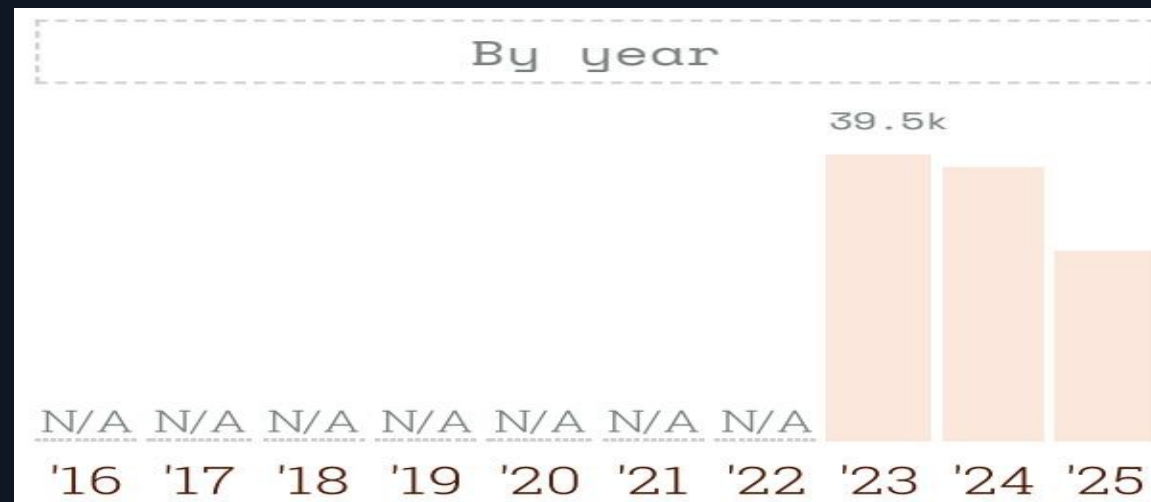
Blocks (layout collections for typical web apps)

New responsive sidebar component

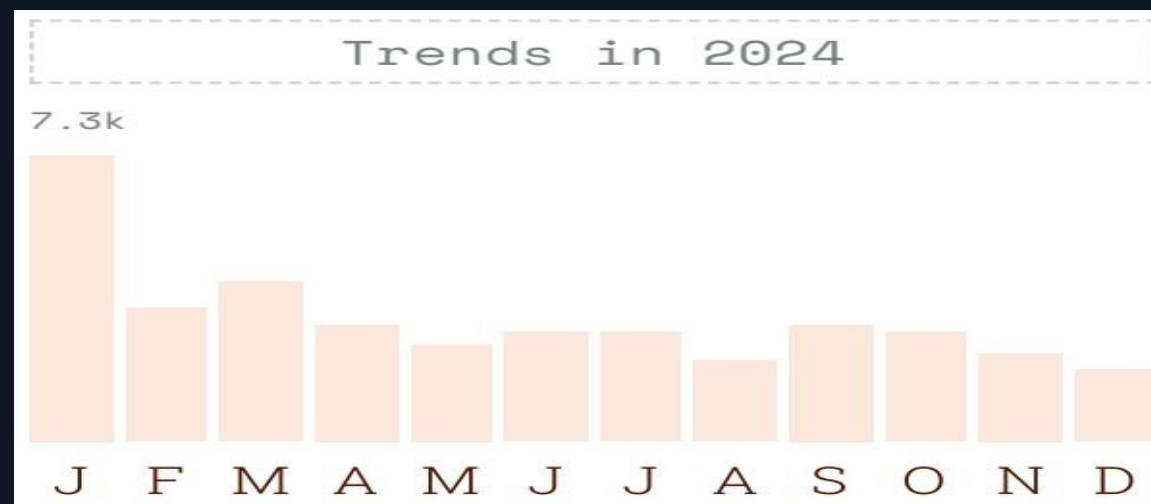
Upgraded CLI: Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos

Ecosystem registries: Motion-Primitives, Magic UI

Integration with Vercel v0 for AI-generated components



Yearly star trend: N/A 2016-2022 → 39.5k (2023) → 38.0k (2024)



Monthly trend in 2024: January peak at 7.3k, steady 2-3k monthly

htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars Added



htmx

Rose from #2 in 2023 to #1 in 2024. Extends HTML with hx-* attributes for data fetching and interactivity without writing JavaScript — ideal for server-driven apps and progressive enhancement.

React 19

Launched December after three years of development. New features: Server Components, Server Functions, web component support, new hooks, and form actions. React is evolving from a library into a specification for frameworks.

Svelte 5 introduced runes — explicit reactive state. Holds the highest positive opinion in the State of JS survey.

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload

Dominate

shadcn/ui

+38.0k

Excalidraw

+27.0k

Payload

+14.4k

Magic UI

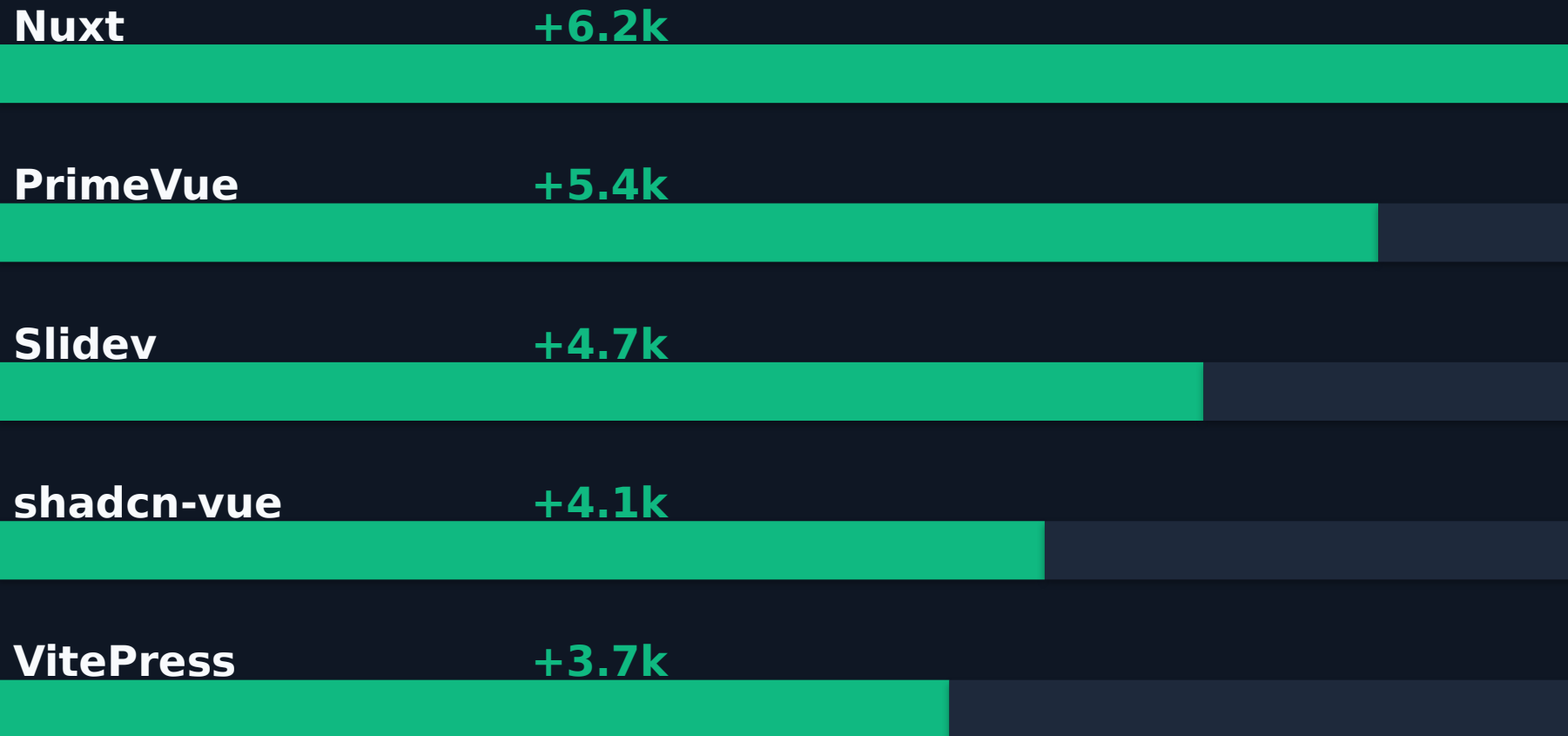
+13.2k

Next.js

+12.1k

React is becoming a framework specification rather than a standalone library. With Server Components and Server Functions in React 19, frameworks like Next.js and Remix now interpret React primitives differently.

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead Growth



Vue 3.5 reworked its reactivity system, with the lighter alien-signals approach already landing in main. A wave of high-quality UI libraries signals growing ecosystem confidence.

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser-Based Innovation Shape 2024

AI-Powered Automation

n8n (+17.0k)
Flowise (+14.5k)
Visual workflow builders with native LLM integrations.

Desktop & Mobile

Tauri (+15.9k)
Lighter desktop/mobile apps built with web frontends — Rust-powered alternative to Electron.

Browser Innovation

PGlite (Postgres via WASM)
WebVM (VM in the browser)
Pushing the edge of what runs client-side.

Open-Source Backend

Supabase (+14.5k)
Firebase alternative with growing AI feature set and strong community momentum.

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

1 Component ownership beats imports

shadcn/ui's model of letting developers own and customize component code proved its staying power for a second year, reaching 77.5k total stars.

2 HTML-first is serious

htmx overtook React as the #1 front-end framework by stars added, validating server-driven, low-JavaScript architectures.

3 React is becoming a framework spec

With Server Components and Server Functions in React 19, multiple frameworks now interpret React's primitives differently.

4 AI integration is table stakes

Four of the top 10 overall projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have significant AI capabilities or integrations.

5 Vue's ecosystem maturity

A wave of high-quality UI libraries and the Vue 3.5 reactivity overhaul signal a confident, maturing Vue ecosystem.

Heading into 2025: expect deeper AI-native tooling, continued server-driven UI growth, and framework specialization over general-purpose libraries.